

ANUSHA M

Business Analyst | Banking & Financial Services

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Business Analyst with 7+ years of experience delivering requirements-driven solutions across banking, capital markets, and investment management domains. Proven expertise in gathering, analyzing, and documenting business requirements; translating complex needs into functional requirements and user stories; and conducting gap analysis to recommend measurable process improvements. Strong analytical and problem-solving skills with hands-on SQL, Power BI, and Tableau for data-driven insights. Adept at supporting Agile ceremonies including sprint planning, backlog refinement, and UAT while managing risks, issues, and change requests throughout the project lifecycle. Consistently ensures delivered solutions meet business objectives and quality standards through clear stakeholder communication and cross-functional collaboration. Experienced in supporting and configuring trading platforms, loan servicing systems like Loan IQ, and core banking infrastructure including Finacle and Salesforce. Adept at designing and executing UAT plans, automated test strategies, and API validation workflows to ensure robust system performance. Holds a Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) in Computer Science with a demonstrated track record of bridging business and technology teams across hybrid Agile-Waterfall environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Requirement Management: JIRA, Confluence, Azure DevOps, BRD, FRD, User Stories, Acceptance Criteria, Use Cases, Traceability Matrix, Functional Specifications, RFQ Documentation

SDLC & Agile Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, Waterfall, Hybrid Agile-Waterfall, Sprint Planning, Backlog Grooming, Daily Standups, Sprint Reviews, Retrospectives, UAT, Agile Ceremonies, Release Planning, Roadmap Development

Banking & Financial Domain: Retail Banking, Commercial Banking, Loans, Payments, ACH, Wire, SWIFT, Zelle Integration, Capital Markets, AML, KYC, SOX, Basel III, IFRS, Regulatory Compliance, Trade Lifecycle, Portfolio Management, Loan Servicing, Loan IQ, Trade Underwriting

Data Analysis & Reporting: SQL, Complex Queries, Data Analysis, Reporting, Advanced Excel, Pivot Tables, VBA, Macros, Power Query, SQL Reporting Services, Hadoop, Data Validation, Root Cause Analysis, Reconciliation Reporting

Data Visualization & BI: Power BI, Tableau, Data Warehousing, ETL, Informatica, SSIS, Snowflake, Dashboard Design, Client Reporting Dashboards, Portfolio Performance Dashboards

API & System Integration: REST APIs, SOAP APIs, JSON, XML, Postman, API Validation, System Integration, Third-Party Data Integration, Data Exchange Validation

Process Modeling & Testing: MS Visio, Lucidchart, ARIS, UML Diagrams, BPMN, AS-IS/TO-BE Process Flows, Data Flow Diagrams, Test Case Creation, Test Plans, Functional Testing, System Integration Testing, SIT, Automated Test Scripts, Selenium, Test Data Preparation

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure DevOps, GCP, Azure Fundamentals, Cloud Migration Support

Core Banking & CRM Systems: Loan IQ, Salesforce, Finacle, Core Banking Systems, CRM Platforms, Trading Platforms, Risk Management Systems

Office & Collaboration Tools: Microsoft Excel, Microsoft Word, Microsoft PowerPoint, Microsoft Teams, SharePoint

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Business Analyst

BMO Bank, Chicago, IL

Feb 2023 – Present

- Directed end-to-end requirement lifecycle for digital banking and payments transformation initiatives, collaborating with business stakeholders, product managers, and technology teams to define clear business objectives, functional requirements, and KPIs.
- Gathered and documented comprehensive business requirements through JAD workshops, stakeholder interviews, and structured elicitation sessions, translating complex banking needs into actionable user stories with detailed acceptance criteria in JIRA and Confluence.
- Translated business needs into Business Requirement Documents (BRDs), Functional Requirement Documents (FRDs), use cases, and process flows, ensuring alignment with Agile Scrum delivery models and stakeholder expectations.
- Partnered with compliance teams to ensure adherence to AML, KYC, SOX, and Basel III regulatory frameworks, incorporating required controls into business and system specifications.
- Performed data analysis using SQL, Tableau, and Power BI to generate actionable insights, validate business assumptions, and support strategic decision-making across retail and commercial banking operations.
- Analyzed ACH, Wire, and SWIFT payment processing workflows, conducted gap analysis, and recommended process improvements that streamlined settlement and reconciliation procedures.
- Created and maintained detailed AS-IS and TO-BE process flow diagrams, data mapping documents, and UML diagrams using MS Visio and Lucidchart to support system design and operational enhancements.
- Drove digital transformation initiatives including online banking enhancements, customer onboarding optimization, and automation of manual workflows, leveraging cloud-based platforms such as Azure DevOps and AWS.
- Provided regular status reports, dashboards, and progress tracking to senior leadership, highlighting project risks, issues, and key performance indicators while managing change requests and mitigating delivery risks.
- Acted as the primary liaison between business and IT teams, ensuring clear communication, requirement traceability, and alignment of delivered solutions with strategic banking objectives and quality standards.
- Designed and implemented REST API integration requirements for third-party payments platforms, enabling secure data exchange between core banking systems and external financial service providers.
- Executed UAT planning and test case development for digital banking releases, coordinating cross-functional review sessions with business users and QA teams to validate system functionality against acceptance criteria.
- Standardized requirement documentation templates across the payments transformation program, improving consistency and reducing rework during sprint deliveries.
- Deployed Power BI dashboards tracking ACH processing volume, Wire settlement timelines, and exception rates, enabling operations teams to monitor transaction health in real time.
- Negotiated prioritization of backlog items with product owners across multiple Agile squads, ensuring critical regulatory and business deliverables remained on track within sprint cycles.

Environment: Digital Banking, Payments (ACH, Wire, SWIFT), Agile (Scrum), SAFe, JIRA, Confluence, Azure DevOps, AWS, SQL, Power BI, Tableau, REST APIs, Core Banking Systems, Loan IQ, Salesforce, Finacle, AML/KYC, SOX, Basel III, UAT, Selenium, MS Visio, MS Excel, MS Word, MS PowerPoint, Microsoft Teams, SharePoint.

Business Analyst

Oct 2021 – Jan 2023

B. Riley Financial, Los Angeles, CA

- Developed end-to-end business analysis for capital markets and advisory platforms, supporting the full deal lifecycle including underwriting, trading, due diligence, and financial reporting with a focus on delivering functional requirements and user stories.
- Collaborated with investment bankers, traders, and portfolio managers to gather and document business requirements for equity research, asset management, and restructuring engagements, ensuring alignment with stakeholder objectives.
- Conducted detailed JAD workshop sessions and translated complex financial needs into BRDs, FRDs, and user stories aligned with Agile/Scrum methodology, managing traceability through JIRA and Confluence.
- Analyzed financial datasets, trading data, and portfolio performance metrics using SQL and Excel to identify trends, assess risks, and surface actionable business opportunities for mid-market investment strategies.

- Worked on regulatory and compliance initiatives ensuring alignment with SEC, FINRA, and internal audit requirements, incorporating controls and documentation standards into business specifications.
- Designed and validated data mapping, data lineage, and ETL specifications for financial data integration across multiple capital markets systems, ensuring accuracy and completeness of downstream reporting.
- Engineered interactive dashboards in Tableau and Power BI to provide real-time insights into revenue performance, deal pipeline velocity, and asset valuation for senior leadership and portfolio managers.
- Facilitated User Acceptance Testing (UAT) by creating comprehensive test cases, coordinating stakeholder reviews, and ensuring successful validation of all business requirements prior to production deployment.
- Managed change requests, conducted impact and gap analyses, and tracked issues throughout the project lifecycle, ensuring delivered solutions met defined business objectives and quality standards.
- Partnered with technology teams to support the implementation of trading platforms, risk management systems, and operational reporting dashboards across the capital markets technology stack.
- Authored test plans and coordinated test data preparation for SIT and UAT phases, ensuring realistic financial datasets were available for comprehensive system validation.
- Streamlined deal pipeline tracking by designing and deploying Tableau dashboards that consolidated revenue performance, deal stage velocity, and advisor productivity metrics into a single executive view.
- Re-engineered manual reconciliation workflows between trading platforms and internal reporting systems by specifying automated data pipeline requirements, reducing end-of-day processing time significantly.
- Modeled AS-IS and TO-BE business processes for capital markets deal lifecycle using BPMN and MS Visio, identifying bottleneck steps and recommending technology-enabled automation opportunities.

Environment: Capital Markets, Agile/Scrum, SAFe, JIRA, Confluence, Azure DevOps, SQL, ETL, Informatica, SSIS, Tableau, Power BI, MS Visio, UAT, Selenium, SEC/FINRA Compliance, REST APIs, Postman, MS Excel, MS Word, MS PowerPoint, Microsoft Teams, SharePoint.

Business Analyst

Feb 2019 – Jun 2021

Invesco, Hyderabad, India

- Collaborated with portfolio managers, traders, and operations teams to gather and document business requirements for investment management and asset servicing platforms supporting end-to-end trade lifecycle, portfolio valuation, and performance reporting.
- Analyzed front-office and middle-office workflows including trade lifecycle, portfolio valuation, and performance reporting to identify process improvement opportunities and recommend actionable enhancements.
- Elicited and documented functional and non-functional requirements, creating BRDs, FRDs, user stories, and acceptance criteria aligned with Agile/Scrum delivery models.
- Utilized SQL to perform complex data analysis on large investment datasets, validating trade transactions, holdings, and pricing data across multiple asset classes to ensure data integrity.
- Built interactive dashboards in Tableau and Power BI to track portfolio performance, benchmark comparisons, and risk exposure metrics for internal stakeholders and investment committees.
- Evaluated and automated reconciliation reports using Advanced Excel (Pivot Tables, Power Query, VBA, Macros), significantly reducing manual effort in financial data validation processes.
- Designed process flow diagrams and system workflows using MS Visio and Lucidchart to visualize end-to-end investment operations, enabling clear identification of bottlenecks and improvement areas.
- Monitored project progress and managed risks and issues through regular stakeholder communication, ensuring clear alignment between business objectives and delivered solution quality.
- Consolidated fragmented client reporting workflows by specifying integrated data pipelines between Snowflake, ETL tools, and Power BI, enabling automated generation of portfolio performance reports.
- Reduced reconciliation processing time by automating repetitive data validation tasks through Python scripting and Excel macro development, freeing up team capacity for higher-value analysis.

- Validated API integrations between portfolio management systems and external market data vendors using Postman, ensuring accurate and timely data exchange for pricing and benchmark feeds.
- Conducted root cause analysis on data discrepancies identified during trade validation, documenting findings and coordinating with data engineering teams to implement corrective ETL adjustments.
- Assisted in test data preparation and environment setup, ensuring realistic datasets for SIT and UAT phases and validating release outcomes against defined acceptance criteria.
- Designed and validated client reporting dashboards using tools like Tableau and Power BI for portfolio performance and risk metrics, ensuring alignment with investment committee review requirements.

Environment: Snowflake, SQL, Tableau, Power BI, JIRA, Confluence, Azure DevOps, Advanced Excel (Pivot Tables, Power Query, VBA, Macros), Python (basic scripting), Postman, MS Visio, Lucidchart, ETL/Data Mapping tools, Informatica, SSIS, UAT, Functional Testing, Agile/Scrum, MS Word, MS PowerPoint, Microsoft Teams, SharePoint.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) in Computer Science — Usha Rama College of Engineering and Technology (affiliated to JNTUK), Hyderabad, India, 2020